

Everlasting grace of God

8: In a surge of anger, I hid my face from you for a moment,
but with everlasting kindness, I will have compassion on you,”
says the Lord your Redeemer.

10: Though the mountains be shaken and the hills be removed,
yet my unfailing love for you will not be shaken nor my covenant of peace be
removed,” says the Lord, who has compassion on you.

We see these two beautiful and meaningful verse. And these two verses paint a picture for us about Gods Everlasting Grace.

But before we talk about Everlasting Grace - Let's talk about what Grace is.

- **Ephesians 2:8 For by grace you have been saved through faith. And this is not your own doing; it is the gift of God, not a result of works, so that no one may boast it is an undisputed & undeserved - Marakka Mudiyaatha & kadaku kudaathu**
oru Gift / Parisu that is given to us by God. We cannot earn it - *I come daily to church, I do so much work for the church, I give so much to the church, I work tirelessly for the church in the vestry, Oh I have been appointed as Youth President - surely I must deserve kattaayum grace of God. Oh I am a part of the Choir.* No, it is a gift of God that is freely given to us. All these things are not written in Gods account. We cannot buy it - We cannot go to the South Indian store like we say Anna Rendu kilo idli paruppu, we cannot say oru kilo grace kudutha nalla irukku. We cannot argue for it. We cannot say how does this person have more grace than me. Grace is measured to each person accordingly. We can only say **Thank you God. We can only say Nandri Yesappa.**

- **John 1:16- Grace upon Grace** - in terms of maths, name church la **Maths TIGER**
irukaanga yepdi solurudhu nariya kanakku la puli - irukaanga, neenga calculate panula
- Grace is compounded upon Grace. It is never ending. Grace is like an ocean. To our human eyes, we think it's like a swimming pool. We think that because we don't know the intensity of gods grace. Because many times we take Grace for granted saadaranuma . In everyday lives we overlook the grace of God, because we like to think we deserve more. But no - every grace of God that we receive is not just grace - It is GRACE UPON GRACE.
- **Titus 2:11 - For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation for **all** people,**
Grace is one of the true characteristic of God. Kadaval odu our Panbu. Only in Christianity - there is concept of free gift. Wether you like it or not it is still there. In many different religions Grace is an outcome of what you sacrifice, what you give to the church: what you give to people.
- EPH 2:8 For by grace you have been **saved through faith**. Gods Grace is the reward of our Faith. We are able to understand the Grace of god only when we practice Faith, and surrender to his will. Not Good works. Gods GRACE is also an example for us. God judged us not by our works. But gives grace freely. Hence, it puts us in a responsible position - to endure the trials of Life with with faith (***Caavulgalai tāṅkum our nabikkai odu***) To treat one another with the same grace. If we don't treat others with grace, Gods grace will be taken away. It is gift that we are supposed to share with one another.

Now let's talk about what everlasting Grace is -

The same grace that God showed Noah, Abraham & Mos is the same grace that he shows you & I. During the floods God's covenant was to never again flood the earth. And we live in that promise to this day. Just like God is the same yesterday, today and forever - the Grace of God exists yesterday, today and forever.

But many times, we forget the Everlasting Grace of God. Our journey with the everlasting Grace of God is something like this:

Ignorance - Denial - Acceptance - | Ariyaaamai - Marappu - Etrukollathal -

Our Ignorant response to Gods everlasting Grace -

The Bible says that while we were still sinners Christ died for us. The grace of God did not just end with Christ's Death on the cross. In the roman time, when someone was to be crucified there was a tradition to release one prisoner. When Pontus pilate went to the crowd and said who do you want in exchange - the crowd shouted we want barabbas. Barabbas is mentioned in all the four Gospels as - a thief / Bandit, Murderer, and had committed many crimes against the Roman Empire.

There was no reason for a man such as this to be exchanged. But the people shouted Ignorantly - We want Barabbas. But why did they shout like that? They welcomed Jesus by laying down only a week before.

The people wanted a separation from the roman power. They wanted a freedom. They wanted material & political success. When they did not receive it - they said who is this Jesus? We want Barabbas in exchange.

Many times in our life, when we don't get the things we want. We are just like the people - ignore Jesus. If it's not what I want - Who is this Jesus? We don't want anything to do with Him. We ignore the grace of God, because our wants (**vendiyathu**) are in the way.

We ignore the grace of God, because we don't get want we want. Yenukku idhu illa na adhu illa,

But just because the people shouted we want barabbas, does it make Christ Death selective? Did Christ Die for only the few people who might have said no in the crowd? Or was Jesus' death for everyone even they said we want Barabbas.

The Bible says - I hid my face from you for a moment, but with everlasting Kindness I will have compassion over you.

Our denial to Gods Everlasting Grace -

It is very interesting to think about what would we do if Jesus was in our midst today. What if this Sunday Service Christ came as a simple man, wearing simple clothes. Our Bata chappal, oru T shirt le vandal what would we do.

How many would willingly go and say Hi and introduce ourselves. How many would say please come home for lunch.

The pharisees stood on their High Pedestal, because of their knowledge of the scripture, their high position in society. But they denied Jesus even when He was in front of their eyes. They trusted in their own knowledge. In their own position, they failed to look towards Jesus.

Even today, we see Gods Grace right in front of our eyes. We think it is because of my achievements, my position in the government, my talent, my beauty. We deny Gods grace in front of our eyes, because we are focusing on ourselves.

James 4:6 - God opposes the proud but gives grace to the humble.” Let us not be proud and deny the grace that is in front of eyes.

His grace is everlasting only if we choose to deny ourselves, and accept his love.

This brings us to our next point - Acceptance, Yetrukoladhal

We just read Isaiah 54:8 - In a surge of anger, I hid my face from you for a moment, but with everlasting kindness, I will have compassion on you,” says the Lord your Redeemer.

In this verse it says In my anger - I have hid my face from you. Which means that God has the right to be angry with us.

It is right for God to be angry with us, and select a punishment for us. We think oh I have never committed murder, so my punishment will not be so strong. **James 2 says - For whoever keeps the whole law but fails in one point has become guilty of all of it.**

Even if we spend our whole life, living accordingly to the word. But look at someone with jealousy, or if we think down or less of someone - we are guilty of sin.

This beautiful verse says but with **everlasting kindness, I will have compassion on you,**"

There is a famous quote that says - The Devil knows you by your name, but calls you by your sin. But, God knows your sin, yet calls you by your name.

Let's take a moment to accept the everlasting grace of God today. Even in our Sin, he had the right to be angry with us - but chose to love us.

Our acceptance is as simple as saying 'Thank you Jesus, Nandri yesappa'

Embracing the everlasting Grace of God